Alawi "Mandangan" Dimakuta

Governor Hadji Alawi "Mandangan" Dimakuta served as the provincial chief executive of the undivided Province of Lanao from 1949 to 1953, governing the territory years before it was split in 1959 under Republic Act No. 2228 into Lanao del Norte and Lanao del Sur. He's remembered around the region by the moniker "**ALMADIM**," a name pieced together from Alawi, Mandangan, and Dimakuta.

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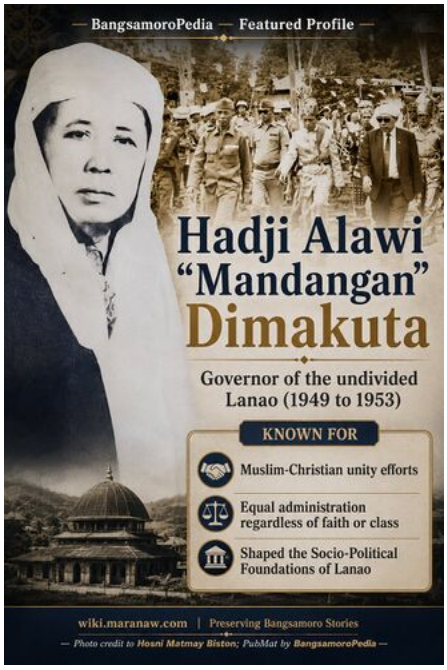
Administration and Core Philosophy

Dimakuta took the helm of Lanao at a time when the province still stood as one piece, long before the lines were drawn that would later define Lanao del Norte and Lanao del Sur as we know them today. His years in office were marked by a steady push toward inter-community bridge-building and the kind of sustainable public service that doesn't make headlines but changes how people live.

He championed Muslim-Christian unity during a developmental era when regional harmony mattered more than ever for peaceful co-existence. People who knew his administration describe a leader who treated everyone the same way: rich or poor, Muslim or Christian, Maranao or otherwise, the same systemic fairness applied across the board.

On the development side, Dimakuta laid down socioeconomic foundations that the province would build on for decades. He funded and pushed forward agricultural production, primary roads, public education, and regional business, the kind of infrastructure work that quietly shapes a region's future.

Governor Hadji Alawi "Mandangan" Dimakuta



Office

Provincial Governor of the undivided Lanao

Term

1949 to 1953

Predecessor / Successor Context

Governed before Lanao was divided in 1959 under Republic Act No. 2228 into Lanao del Norte and Lanao del Sur

Ethnicity

Maranao

Region

Lanao, Mindanao, Philippines

Other Ventures

Founder, Alawi Bus Company

Children

Includes Gov. Linang Mandangan Dimakuta, Director Datudacula Mandangan, Hadja Omairah Dimakuta-Dianalan, Hadja Jamilah Dimakuta-

The Alawi Bus Company

Outside the governor's office, Dimakuta wore another hat: entrepreneur. He launched the **Alawi Bus Company**, a private transportation service that connected isolated municipalities across the region. The buses didn't just move people, they moved opportunity, providing vital logistical links across Mindanao. One detail that stands out: the company even ferried students from as far as Zamboanga City all the way to Marawi, opening doors to education that distance alone would have closed. The business also fueled local livelihoods by making inter-provincial commerce possible in places that had been cut off before.

Dimaporo, Maimona Dimakuta-Mapupuno, Hadja Rahma Dimakuta-Gani

Notability

Governed the undivided Province of Lanao through a critical, formative era, building the civic and economic groundwork that later, separated provinces would inherit

Known For

Muslim-Christian unity efforts, equal administration regardless of faith or class, and founding the Alawi Bus Company

Institutional Memorialization

In recognition of what he built for the region, a major thoroughfare on the main campus of Mindanao State University (MSU) in Marawi City carries his name: **Hj. Alawi Mandangan Dimakuta Street**.

Family and Descendants

Governor Dimakuta's children carried his civic legacy forward in different directions, some staying in government, others marrying into families that would go on to shape the Lanao region's political, legal, and academic landscape.

Sons

His son **Governor Linang Mandangan Dimakuta** followed directly in his father's footsteps, serving as Governor of Lanao del Sur from 1968 to 1971. Linang's governance leaned toward inclusive regional development, strengthening municipal administration, and uplifting marginalized and vulnerable communities across the province.

The patriarch's last son, **Director Datudacula Lamping D. Mandangan, DPA** (also known within the family as DatuDakula Lamping M. Dimakuta), served as Director of the Supply Management Division Office at Mindanao State University. He held the post for more than ten years, overseeing the university's supply and logistics operations during his tenure.

Daughters and Their Husbands

Maranao political influence has long run through strategic family lines, and Dimakuta's daughters were no exception. They married into legal, academic, and executive circles that left deep marks on Philippine history.

Hadja Omairah Dimakuta married **Sultan Atty. Omar Marohom Dianalan**, who became one of the towering figures of Marawi City governance. Dianalan served as Mayor of Dansalan (the town that, under his watch, transitioned into the Islamic City of Marawi) for nearly two decades, focusing his term on building core urban infrastructure and standardizing the municipal market system. Beyond the mayor's office, he held seats as an Assemblyman and as Congressman for the 1st District of Lanao del Sur, while also carrying the traditional title of Sultan of the Royal House of Guimba. During the volatile 1971 Marawi unrest, he leaned on his dual standing as a licensed attorney and traditional sultan to defuse armed communal standoffs, advocating equitable development for citizens of every faith. He's remembered today as a freedom fighter and social reformer.

Hadja Jamilah "Lala" Dimakuta married **Sultan Mohammad Ali B. Dimaporo**, one of the most powerful Muslim politicians in modern Mindanao history. In a political career that's hard to match, Dimaporo served as governor of both separated Lanao provinces at different points: first as Governor of Lanao del Norte from 1960 to 1965, then later as Governor of Lanao del Sur from 1976 to 1986.<ref name="rappler">Lanao del Sur Wikipedia entry, governors list, retrieved 2026.</ref> He also represented the Lanao region in Congress across several decades, becoming a vital ally in national politics and shaping much of Mindanao's political trajectory. On the academic front, Dimaporo served as President of Mindanao State University, using the position to expand access to higher education and secure heavy institutional budget support, cementing MSU's role as a driver of regional growth.

Maimona Dimakuta married **Atty. Khalil Oga Mangurun Mapupuno**, a respected legal practitioner who was elected delegate to the historic 1971 Constitutional Convention, representing Lanao del Sur. Working through the convention's debates during the lead-up to and onset of the Martial Law era, Mapupuno put his legal training directly into the drafting and structural shaping of the nation's fundamental law.

Hadja Rahma Dimakuta married **Tominaman Gani**, who took his civic work in a different direction altogether, away from bureaucratic office and toward grassroots community development. Gani devoted himself to rural livelihood development across the Lanao provinces and stood as a strong advocate for social justice, building frameworks that made sure marginalized agricultural and rural sectors actually benefited from the region's economic progress.

See Also

- Lanao del Sur
- Lanao del Norte
- Mindanao State University
- Mohammad Ali Dimaporo
- Omar Dianalan

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